Question 1

What is the average activity of the output of a 32-bit binary counter when incrementing every clock cycle?

Here is how we are going to think about this. Every bit in the counter will change after some amount of cycle, and since this is a simple counter, we could determine the number of cycles it would take before a bit would toggle. This value is taken as the following.

$$2^{\text{bit position}}$$

Where the bit position is a 0-based bit index starting from the LSB. Now, we could find the rate of toggling by inverting this value.

$$2^{-(\text{bit position})}$$

Now since we are looking at the output of a binary counter, each bit only has a weight of 1/32. From here, we could find the contribution of the different bits by summing the product of the rate of toggle with the contribution to the activity factor. This is represented with the following expression.

$$\alpha(n) = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}\frac{1}{2^i}$$

Where n, is the number of bits of the counter output.

```
(define (alpha n)
  (define (alpha-iter acc iter)
    (if (>= iter n)
        acc
        (alpha-iter (+ acc (/ 1 (arithmetic-shift 1 iter)))
                    (+ iter 1))))
  (* (/ 1 n) (alpha-iter 0 0)))

(exact->inexact
 (alpha counter-size))
```

Listing 1: Racket implementation used to find α

From here, we found that the α of the 32 bit counter is `0.062499999985448085`.

Question 2

For a static CMOS with a clock frequency of 1 GHz, $V_{dd} = 1.2$ V, with a total internal parasitic capacitance per bit of the counter of 40 fF and a load capacitance per bit of 90 fF, what is the dynamic power consumption? Assume no glitches in the combinational logic.

$$P_{dyn} = \alpha f_{clk} V_{dd}^2 C \tag{1}$$

Where we have the following value for C.

$$C = 32 \times (40\,\text{fF} + 90\,\text{fF})$$

We could just compute this using racket again. The code is available in listing 2.

```
(define (dyn-power alpha capacitance f_clk V_dd)
  (* alpha f_clk (* V_dd V_dd) capacitance))
(~a (exact->inexact
 (dyn-power alpha f_clk V_dd capacitance)) " W" )
```

Listing 2: Racket implementation used to find the dynamic power of the output to the counter.

And so we found that the power used is `1.2674999997048872e-12 W`.

Question 3

You have been asked to design the signalling used on 500 µm wire on an integrated circuit to minimize power consumption. Your options are full-swing static CMOS or low voltage swing 200 mV signalling, both single-ended. The minimum width wire has a capacitance of 250 pF m^{-1}. The system clock is 500 MHz and the signal has an activity of 0.45.V_{DD} is 0.9 V. Both receivers have an input capacitance of 30 fF. The receiver for low voltage signalling consumes 30 µA from V_{DD} continuously (assume independent of f_c and noise margins are sufficient). Assume that unspecified values are negligible.

$$P_{dyn,low-swing} = \alpha C f V_{swing} V_{driver} \tag{2}$$

Part a

Find the total capacitance driven by the full-swing static CMOS driver.

Find the power consumption of the driver.

Looking at the capacitance of the wire, we have the following expression.

$$500\,\mu\text{m} \times 250\,\text{pF}\,\text{m}^{-1}$$

```
(* 500e-6 250e-12)
```

Listing 3: Quick code used to find the wire capacitance.

With this, we could add the value of the input capacitance of the receiver to the wire capacitance to get the total value of the capacitance.

```
(+ wire-cap 30e-15)
```

Listing 4: Quick code used to find the wire capacitance.

This results in `1.5500000000000002e-13` F.

Due to having static power consumption be unspecified, we assume that only dynamic power are contributing to the full swing power usage.

Using (1), we are able to find the power usage of the full swing driver.

```
(* 500e6 (* 0.9 0.9) total-cap 0.45)
```

Listing 5: The expression for the power usage of the driver when using full swing signalling.

```
2.8248750000000003e-05
```

Using listing 5, we are able to find $P_{full-swing}$ to be `2.8248750000000003e-05` W.

Part b

Using low swing signalling, find the power consumption of the driver plus receiver. The driver and receiver must take their power from V_{DD}.

The dynamic power expression for the low-swing signalling is available in (2).

Part c

At what clock frequency would power consumption of the two options be equal?